ROLEEDGE · CAREER

Career Strategy Playbook

Build, Navigate, and Future-Proof Your Career

13	10	Print
SECTIONS	EXERCISES	WITH SPACE TO WRITE

> **How to use this guide:** print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

Why You Need a Career Strategy

Most professionals drift through careers, chasing the next promotion or job switch without a bigger picture. The result? Burnout, mismatched roles, and stagnation.

A career strategy ensures that every move—MBA, job switch, skill acquisition—aligns with your **long-term goals**. Think of it like financial planning: structured, intentional, and focused on compounding results.

REFLECTION

Do you currently make career moves reactively (chasing opportunities) or proactively (shaping opportunities)?

STEP 1

Define Your Long-Term Career Vision

Ask yourself: What do I want my professional legacy to be?

- Do you aspire to be a Partner at a consulting firm?
- A CFO leading financial strategy?
- A Product Head driving tech innovation?

Your long-term vision guides short-term choices.

EXERCISE

Write a 10-year vision statement for your career.

STEP 2

Set Short-Term and Medium-Term Milestones

Big visions require milestones. Example:

- **Short-Term (1–2 years):** Get into consulting via Big 4.
- **Medium-Term (3–5 years):** Move to MBB or strategy role in Fortune 500.
- **Long-Term (10 years):** Partner / CXO role.

WORKSHEET

Map 1 short-term and 1 medium-term milestone toward your vision.

	Milestone	By when
Short term (1–2 years)		
Medium term (3–5 years)		
Long term (10 years)		

STEP 3

Identify Your Core Strengths & Development Areas

Clarity on your strengths lets you double down; clarity on weaknesses helps you upskill.

Framework:

- Strengths = what you do better than peers.
- Weaknesses = gaps that limit growth.

EXERCISE

Ask 3 colleagues: “What do I do best?” and “Where should I improve?” Note down themes.

Colleague	What I do best	Where I should improve

STEP 4

Map Your Career Against Market Trends

Industries evolve fast. Roles today may not exist tomorrow. Align your strategy with **future demand.**

- Consulting: Digital, ESG, analytics.
- Finance: Fintech, sustainable investing.
- Tech: AI, cloud, cybersecurity.

EXERCISE

Identify 1 macro-trend in your industry. Write how you'll align your career with it.

STEP 5

Build a Personal Brand That Attracts Opportunities

Your brand = how the market perceives you. Build it by:

- Sharing insights on LinkedIn.
- Speaking at webinars.
- Publishing blogs or whitepapers.

When recruiters Google you, they should see **evidence of expertise.**

EXERCISE

Write a 1-sentence "positioning statement" (e.g., Finance professional passionate about ESG investing).

STEP 6

Leverage Networking Strategically

Networking isn't random—it's targeted. Build **3 networks:**

- Internal mentors.
- Industry peers.
- Recruiters & headhunters.

EXERCISE

Make a list of 5 people you'll reach out to this month.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

STEP 7

Upskill Continuously and Smartly

Don't learn everything. Learn strategically. Example:

- Consultant? Learn AI strategy, data storytelling.
- Banker? Learn Python, fintech regulation.
- Tech professional? Learn product frameworks.

EXERCISE

Pick 1 skill that boosts your long-term vision.

_____

_____

_____

_____

STEP 8

Create a Career Portfolio, Not Just a Job History

A job is temporary. A **career portfolio** is the sum of your skills, networks, and projects. Build assets that outlive jobs: certifications, thought leadership, side hustles.

REFLECTION

What assets are you building beyond your current job?

STEP 9

Plan for Career Pivots and Transitions

Few careers are linear. Be ready to pivot. Example:

- Consulting → VC → Entrepreneurship.
- Finance → ESG → Policy.
- Tech → Product → Strategy.

EXERCISE

Write down one “Plan B” career path if your current plan doesn’t work out.

EXAMPLE

Strategy Consulting Career Path

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Rohit joined a Big Four firm after his MBA. With mentorship, he moved to a strategy consulting firm within 3 years. By strategically publishing LinkedIn insights on digital transformation, he built thought leadership and accelerated to Manager within 6 years.

> LESSON
> Career strategy = **intentional positioning + execution.**

EXAMPLE

Tech to Product Management Transition

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Megha, a software engineer, realized coding wasn't her long-term path. With guidance, she pursued a 1-year MBA, networked into a fintech startup, and now leads product strategy.

> LESSON
> Pivoting early + aligning skills = exponential growth.

Common Mistakes and Your 90-Day Plan

Mistakes: Drifting without vision, ignoring trends, waiting for promotions.

Fix: Define vision, rebrand, network, upskill.

Your 90-day plan

When	Focus	My actions
Days 1–30	Define vision + audit skills.	
Days 31–60	Refresh branding + begin networking.	
Days 61–90	Target opportunities aligned to vision.	

My notes

NEXT STEP

Want someone to check your work?

Bring this guide to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book